

Bribery & Gift Issues in workplace

Insights From Fleddermann

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Engineering Ethics

Engineering ethics refers to moral principles that guide engineers to act honestly, responsibly, and professionally. Engineers must prioritize public safety, fairness, and integrity.



Why Ethics Matter in the Workplace:

01

**Engineers make
decisions that effect
lives**

02

**Trust is built on
honesty**

03

**One wrong choice
can cause serious
harm**

“Engineering isn’t just calculations — it’s responsibility.”



What is Bribery?

“Buying a decision”

- Given to influence a decision or action
- Has an expectation of return favor
- Usually illegal or unethical





What is a Gift?

"A Gesture or a Trap?"

- Given as a token of appreciation
- No expectation of favor in return
- Given after a service or on occasions



Why Gifts and Bribery Create Ethical Problems:

- Can influence decisions unfairly
- Create conflict of interest
- Damage trust and credibility
- Lead to favoritism and bias
- Violate laws, rules, or professional codes
- Reduce transparency and fairness



“Gray Area Between Gift and Bribe”

- Intention is unclear
- Timing can raise suspicion
- Value of gift may be excessive
- Expectation of favor may exist

“This is where engineers must think, not guess.”



Fleddermann's Ethical Questions:

"Ask Yourself These Questions"

- Why is it being given?
- How valuable is it?
- Can it be openly disclosed?
- Do I feel obligated?



“Professional Codes of Ethics”

Why they Exist?

- Honesty
- Objectivity
- Protection of Public Safety

“These codes exist to protect society – and us.”



Conflict of Interest

“When Personal Gain Clouds Judgment”

- Fairness is compromised
- Decisions lose credibility
- Ethics are weakened



Impact of Bribery

“Who Really Pays the Price?”

- Endangers public safety
- Damages company reputation
- Leads to unfair practices
- Harms engineer's career



Legal and Professional Consequences

"The Cost of One Wrong Choice"

- Monetary fines
- Job Loss
- Legal action or imprisonment
- Cancellation of professional license



CASE STUDY

- Contractor offers an expensive smartphone
- Gift given before contract decision
- Engineer is in a decision-making position

What would you do?



Ethical Analysis

Why this is a Problem?

- Gift has high monetary value
- Creates a sense of obligation
- Influences fairness and objectivity
- Violates ethical standards



How Engineers Should Respond?

- Politely refuse the gift
- Report the incident to management
- Follow company and professional policies

Preventive Measures

- Clear company ethics policies
- Transparency in decision-making
- Strong reporting and monitoring systems

**“Stop the
Problem Before
it Starts”**



“Ethics is a Choice”

- Not made in Classrooms
- Made in Real Situations
- When no one is Watching

“As future engineers, our integrity is our strongest tool.”

